Night Trains of Europe

A field guide for sleeping on rails

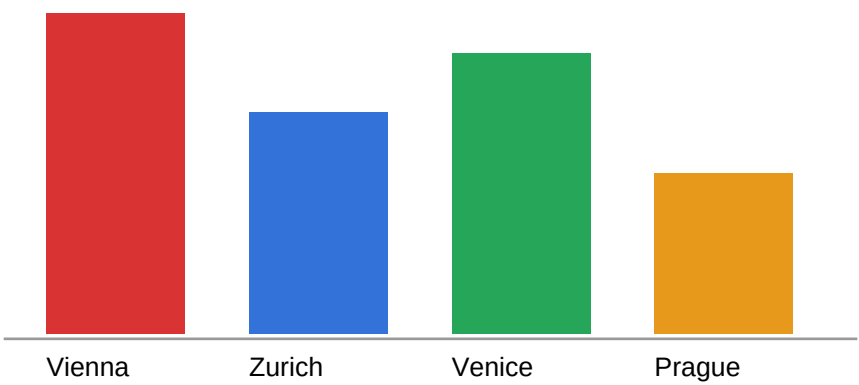
The night train is the slowest way to cross a continent and the only one that gives the hours back. You board after dinner, the city slides away, and by the time the light returns you are somewhere with a different name for bread.

Booking

Seats open about three months ahead. Couchettes fill first, sleepers last, and the lower berth is always the first to go. Book the whole route as one ticket so a late departure is the railway’s problem and not yours.

Where the berths go first

Share of lower berths gone a month out.



Source: the author’s own timetable notes.